

Reserve €225k for Czechia + Spain; start with Spain

BASE ANNUAL INCREMENT

€198.1k

after recurring fixed cost

RESOURCE COMMITMENT

5 FTE

two hubs; capex ceiling €450k

BASE SIMPLE PAYBACK

1.14 yr

run-rate quotient, not cash recovery

Conditional recommendation: reserve the envelope, release Spain first, and gate Czechia on demand, savings and FX evidence.

The pair leads low, base and high scenarios. Netherlands + Spain is stronger in stress. No uplift probability or causal hub effect has been established.

Critical finding: all unit-saving assumptions exceed recorded fulfillment cost per unit. This must be resolved before full commitment. Sources: [\[S06\]](#) [\[S12\]](#); calculations in the companion workbook.

A reconciled €2.03m contribution base supports the model

2025 SHIPPED ORDERS 1,254 77,436 shipped units	NET SALES €4.384m €80,830.57 refunds at cutoff	CONTRIBUTION MARGIN 46.31% contribution / net sales
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Orders: 1,328 raw rows → 1,254 included	Returns: 264 rows → 241 included IDs
13 identical duplicates; 18 superseded revisions	20 identical duplicates; one superseded revision
24 cancellations; 18 tests; one future order excluded	31 Jan included; 1 Feb excluded; one orphan quarantined
12 free orders / 739 units retained	Only 481 of 1,081 returned units recover COGS

Shipment-cohort revenue is not cash. Contribution subtracts net COGS and nonrefundable fulfillment, before corporate overhead, tax, finance and depreciation. No live client account or customer interviews. [\[S02\]](#) [\[S07\]](#) [\[S08\]](#) [\[S09\]](#) [\[S11\]](#) [\[S14\]](#)

Spain and Czechia lead contribution, with higher return rates

2025 market	Units shipped	Contribution €k	Margin	Returned units %
DEU	12,153	262.4	41.9%	0.60%
FRA	11,880	276.3	43.7%	1.21%
NLD	12,576	315.6	45.2%	1.15%
POL	13,163	356.5	46.8%	1.37%
CZE	13,733	397.3	48.7%	2.10%
ESP	13,931	421.9	49.6%	1.81%

All six countries have 209 eligible orders. Spain and Czechia generate 40.4% of total contribution; this reflects cohort economics, not proven hub demand.

Sources: reconciled synthetic shipments and returns [S07] [S08] [S09] [S11], effective EUR unit costs [S14], original sale-month ECB means [S03]. Service times and return reasons are absent.

Macro context informs the setting; it does not prove demand

Market	2024 population m	2022–24 pop. change	2024 GDP/person US\$
DEU	83.52	+0.41%	56,104
FRA	68.55	+0.54%	46,103
NLD	17.99	+1.65%	67,465
POL	36.56	-0.71%	25,104
CZE	10.91	+2.18%	31,828
ESP	48.85	+2.22%	35,327

Spain and Czechia grew fastest in population; the Netherlands has the highest GDP/person. Germany’s scale alone does not offset its hub cost and staffing burden.

Archived World Bank 2022–2024 series [\[S10\]](#) [\[S05\]](#); lastupdated 2026-07-13. GDP/person is current USD, not PPP or real income growth. No core observations are missing. Full three-year values in report and workbook.

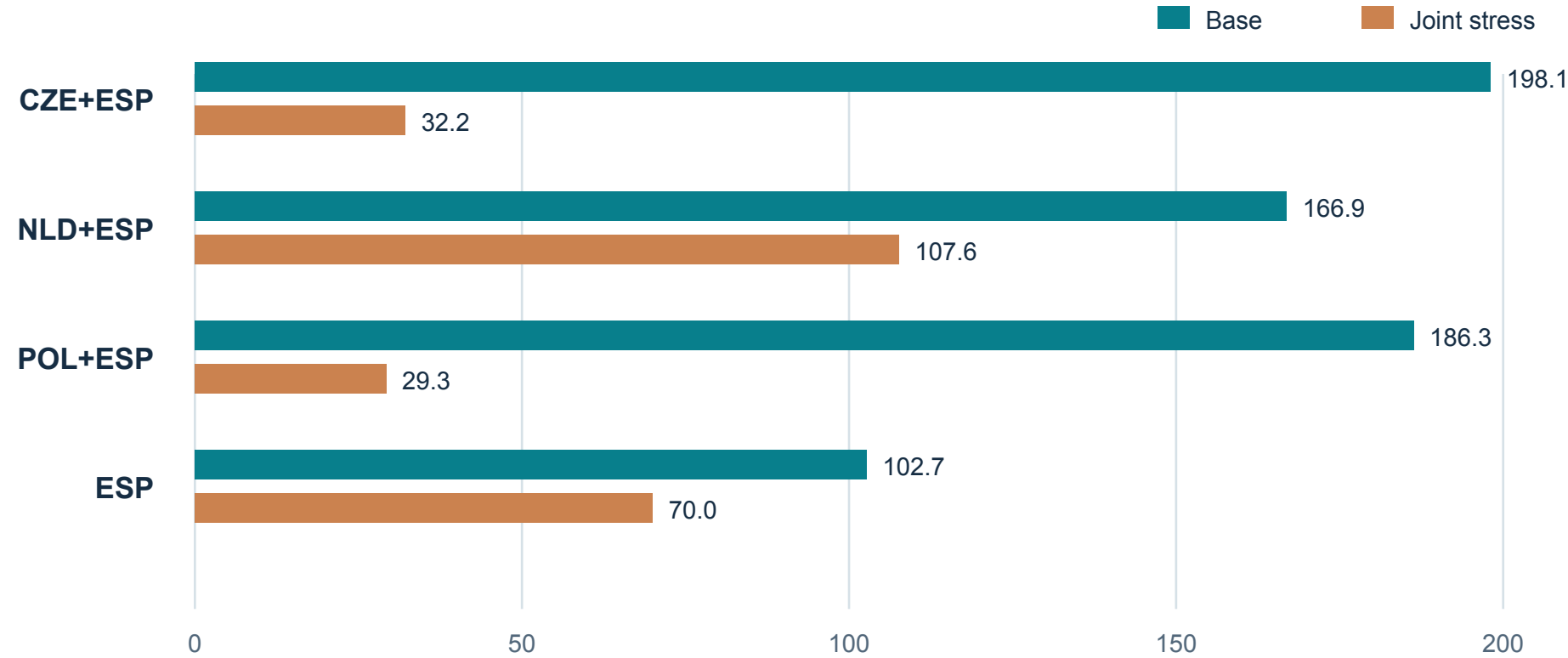
Czechia + Spain wins base; Netherlands + Spain wins stress

Choice	Capex €k / FTE	Low €k	Base €k	High €k	Stress €k
CZE+ESP	225 / 5	64.6	198.1	331.6	32.2
POL+ESP	240 / 6	58.6	186.3	314.1	29.3
NLD+ESP	270 / 6	44.0	166.9	289.9	107.6
ESP	130 / 3	33.2	102.7	172.3	70.0
DEFER	0 / 0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

All 22 choices evaluated; 18 feasible. Germany + France fails capex and FTE. Germany paired with the Netherlands, Poland or Spain fails the seven-FTE ceiling.

Annual increment = $C \times u + U \times (1+u) \times s$ – fixed cost. Uplifts: 10% / 25% / 40%. Stress: base volume, 3% of gross extra refunds, plus 10% of net FX loss in PLN/CZK; unchanged normal baseline. Capex is separate. [\[S06\]](#)
[\[S12\]](#)

Base and stress point to different second hubs



EUR thousands of annual incremental contribution, after recurring fixed cost; capital and staffing constraints applied. NLD+ESP buys €75.5k/year more stress contribution for €31.2k/year less base benefit, €45k more capex and one additional FTE. Source: [S06] [S12].

The savings assumption is the first investment gate

Market	Saving assumed €/unit	Recorded fulfill. €/unit	Ratio
DEU	2.60	1.11	2.35×
FRA	2.90	1.22	2.37×
NLD	3.20	1.32	2.43×
POL	2.40	1.42	1.69×
CZE	2.10	1.52	1.38×
ESP	3.00	1.63	1.84×

Cap savings at recorded fulfillment: CZE+ESP base falls to €164.3k and stress to **-€1.6k**. NLD+ESP remains +€54.2k in stress.

Diagnostic sensitivity, not a replacement client forecast. Even full elimination of recorded fulfillment may be optimistic. CFO + COO must evidence avoided costs and new local variable costs; unrecorded savings cannot be presumed. [\[S06\]](#) [\[S08\]](#) [\[S09\]](#)

The second hub depends on the board's downside preference

CZE+ESP BASE ADVANTAGE

€31.2k/yr

versus NLD+ESP

NLD+ESP STRESS ADVANTAGE

€75.5k/yr

but €45k more capex, +1 FTE

CZE UPLIFT SWITCH

17.69%

if NLD remains at 25%

Base-led preference: choose CZE+ESP. Downside-led preference: choose NLD+ESP. Poland + Spain is the base runner-up but is worse than CZE+ESP on all four modeled scenarios, capex and FTE.

The ranking also flips at €31,167.88 additional annual Czechia fixed cost, or at 29.23% of the full joint stress severity. These are deterministic thresholds, not probabilities.

Czechia alone: -€37,826.95/year stress; Spain offsets this in the policy pair. Pair stress payback is 6.99 years. The analyst preference maximizes base increment subject to hard limits; no weighted scoring or risk tolerance is attributed to the board. [\[S06\]](#) [\[S12\]](#)

Ninety days to evidence, gated commitments and readiness

When	Accountable role	Deliverable / dependency	Release gate
1–15	CFO + Data Lead	Reconcile costs, cash and source gaps	Signed cost-savings bridge; no unresolved material scope
16–30	COO + Procurement + HR	Quotes, staffing, capacity, inventory; after G1	Revised economics and operational prerequisites
31–60	Commercial + Operations	Spain pilot / Czechia demand test; after G2	Adjusted uplift and contribution; no channel double count
61–75	CFO + COO + Board	Compare CZE/NLD/Spain-only/defer	Spain €130k / 3 FTE; Czechia €95k / 2 FTE separately gated
76–90	Program Lead + Country Ops	Phase approved scope; after release	Acceptance and day-90 continue / revise / pause

Proposed owners and schedule; no actual procurement or implementation has occurred. Firm local reviews and readiness are prerequisites. Do not promise full ramp within 90 days; do not spend unused budget merely because it is available.

Track the mechanism, then close the financial loop

Measure / owner	Baseline or modeled target	Review / decision rule
Contribution / CFO	Pair +€198.1k/year base model	Weekly operating bridge; monthly finance close; cash separate
Savings / COO	CZE €2.10; ESP €3.00/unit assumed	Invoice-backed cost bridge; reject unsupported double count
Volume / Commercial	+25% assumed, not measured	Control or phased comparison; adjust mix, availability and cannibalization
Returns / Quality	CZE 2.10%; ESP 1.81% physical	Mature cohorts; track restocking and refund values separately
Service / Country Ops	Baseline absent	Proposed ≥95% on-time, ≥20% faster median, no fill-rate decline
FX / Treasury; capex / CFO	CZE exposed; €225k / 5 FTE reserved	Re-run 10% net FX stress; gate cash and hiring

Management targets are proposed, not source facts or industry benchmarks. Sample size, uncertainty and cohort maturity determine what a pilot can establish. Detailed definitions, cadence and owners are in the executive report.

Approve a conditional envelope, with a credible fallback

Decision proposed: reserve €225,000 and five FTE for Czechia + Spain; Spain first. Make the second-hub decision after cost, demand, FX and cash gates. Retain Netherlands + Spain as the downside alternative and defer as the fallback.

What is supported: the reconciled 2025 base, archived FX and macro comparisons, and exact policy scenario arithmetic.

What is unverified: causal demand uplift, service gains, avoidable-cost scope, staffing/capacity feasibility and calendar cash recovery.

Companion evidence: executive report; formula-linked XLSX; metrics.json; order and return audits; source register and saved bytes; reproduction scripts and verification results.

No customer interviews or live client access. Archived official data remains the core calculation source; public live checks only verify definitions. All scenario assumptions are synthetic. Source attribution: [\[S02\]](#) [\[S03\]](#) [\[S05\]](#) [\[S06\]](#) [\[S07\]](#) [\[S08\]](#) [\[S09\]](#) [\[S10\]](#) [\[S11\]](#) [\[S12\]](#) [\[S14\]](#). OpenSocrates grounding: trade-off-analysis@3.